



Based in San Francisco



EDUCATION

BSC ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING

2016 – 2019 · University of Cape Town

- Graduated with First Class Honours as the top BSc(Eng) student.
- Awarded the prize for the best final-year thesis.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Go, Python, SQL, Git, Docker, gRPC

DOMAINS

Distributed systems · P2P networks · event-driven systems & pipelines · protocol design · database migrations · code review at scale

AGENTIC WORKFLOWS

Daily use of local parallel coding agents (Codex, Claude) · designing features and steering agents through implementation

Outside of work, you can find me in the mountains, looking for rocks to climb, photo hunting, practicing calisthenics, or spending time with friends.

Contact me for references.

Elle Mouton

Backend Software Engineer

About

I am a backend engineer with 5+ years building production-scale distributed systems. My work spans event-driven microservices serving millions of users and protocol-level upgrades to large, live peer-to-peer networks. I thrive in small, fast-moving teams with high ownership and high engineering standards.

I'm especially interested in agentic loops, building experiences, flows, and tools for both developers and non-developers, AI, and event-driven systems.

Experience

⚡ Lightning Infrastructure Engineer | Lightning Labs

2021 – 2026

- Top contributor to [LND](#), the most widely-deployed Bitcoin L2; led developer-tooling work on [Lightning Node Connect](#) and [Lightning Terminal](#).
- Shipped protocol upgrades and large database migrations safely across a live peer-to-peer network of thousands of nodes; led the multi-PR [epic](#) moving LND's graph database to SQL.
- Delivered significant performance improvements — e.g. [~28x on a graph query](#) and [~400x on a filter sync](#).
- Authored public protocol specification extensions ([BLIP-0039 gossip protocol BOLT extension](#)).

🌀 Software Engineer | Luno

2020 – 2021

Backend engineer on the crypto-operations team. Worked in Go on event-driven microservices handling high cryptocurrency volumes for millions of users.

Writing

Deep-dive technical posts on Bitcoin and Lightning Network internals, widely read across the community. ellemouton.com/articles →

Public Appearances



Advancing Bitcoin, London



Connect The World Podcast



The Chaincode Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin++ Brazil